

Netherlands: Provincial /Overseas Territory flags



OVERIJSEL

The yellow and red stripes recall the ancient association of the province with Holland. The wavy blue stripe running across the center is for the Ijssel River, after which the province is named.



UTRECHT

The Archbishop of Utrecht used a red flag with a white cross from 1528. The Archbishop's flag remains in the canton of the modern flag, adopted in 1952. The field is in the traditional colors of the province.



ARUBA

The flag of Aruba was adopted in 1976 when it was still administered as part of the Netherlands Antilles. The flag was retained when Aruba became autonomous in 1986.



SOUTH HOLLAND

The flag is a banner of the arms of Holland and was adopted in this form in 1986, replacing the previous simple triband of yellow-red-yellow, which was also based on the colors of the arms.



ZEELAND

The flag of Zeeland, adopted in 1949, shows its full coat of arms. The wavy blue and white stripes are for the sea and the constant struggle to control it. From the water, the Dutch lion rises in triumph.



NETHERLANDS ANTILLES

Originally adopted in 1959, the flag incorporated the Dutch colors with six stars on the blue stripe, for the island groups. These were reduced to five in 1986 when Aruba left the Netherlands Antilles.